EFTA: THE GATEWAY TO EUROPE PG 10

ANDHRA PRADESH: THREE IS COMPANY PG 14

UPFRONT

WEST BENGAL: MAMATA'S LONE MARCH PG 11

TELANGANA: KCR LOOKS FOR MAYA PG 14



AGNI-V

TOP OF THE LINE

By Amarnath K. Menon

On March 11, Mission Divyastra propelled India into the select club of nations capable of hitting, through a single ballistic missile, several targets spread over hundreds of kilometres at the same time with multiple warheads. The perfect launch of the indigenous Agni-V missile—and its successful integration with the Multiple Independently-targetable Reentry Vehicle (MIRV) technology—from the Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island in Odisha is being seen as a technological breakthrough. MIRV technology allows multiple conventional/ nuclear warheads, programmed to hit different targets at the same time, to be loaded on to a single missile delivery system. Till now, Agni missiles, India's primary land-based delivery systems for nuclear weapons, had the ability to carry one payload. Only five countries—the United States, Russia, China, France and the United Kingdom—have MIRV technology. Developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), Agni-V has a range of 5,000 kilometres.

FIRE AND SMOKE
Agni-V lifts off from Dr APJ Abdul Kalam island off the Odisha coast, March 11